

Start Your Own E-Preneur Venture Using Open Source Tools

For people interested in e-commerce, this article explains the basic concepts for starting an e-preneur venture (also known as an e-commerce website). It also lists various open source tools that help build such a business from scratch.



An e-preneur is someone who uses an opportunity in the digital world to start a venture, which contributes solely to the digital economy. So how's an e-preneur different from an entrepreneur? Entrepreneurs contribute to the economy—physical, digital, or both—through their ventures, but an e-preneur contributes only to the digital economy.

Let's look at the case of Mark Zuckerberg. He saw that students at Harvard needed a common platform from where they could communicate with each other, or get updates of their friends without actually having to interact with them. He grabbed the opportunity and developed Facebook. But do you know what went into the making of Facebook? It was developed using PHP as the scripting language, MySQL as the back-end database, Linux as the OS platform and a few hundred dollars. So did you notice that all these are open source platforms (apart from the money, of course)? This article will show you the possibility of starting an e-preneur venture using open source tools—but before taking the plunge, let's warm up a bit and look at the key ingredients that go into making an e-preneur.

What does it take to be an e-preneur?

- The essential requirement for an e-preneur is an idea, and the essentials of a successful idea are its uniqueness, originality, and the extent to which it satisfies the current as well as future needs of people.
- To be a successful e-preneur, it is good to have an active interest in current and upcoming technologies, because it would enable you to understand the nitty-gritty of the e-commerce platform.
- If you have an idea, and are technically competent enough to either develop an e-commerce portal, or to modify one according to your needs, there's very little left to be funded.
- A strong and vast network of people. Such a network not only serves as a medium of advertising, but also provides you with valuable feedback on how to improve the offerings, serviceability, user experience, etc.
- Skills like innovative thinking, having a long-term vision, etc, come in very handy to brighten the long-term prospects of any e-preneur venture.